

A FREE GIFT FOR THE HUMAN NOTE

Be Your Own Friend

A 10-minute reset for the days you're hardest on yourself.

Five gentle movements, one breath, and three questions that change the voice in your head. No equipment, no floor required, no getting changed. You can do the whole thing in the clothes you're already wearing.

Move like you'd move a friend

Not to burn anything off. Not to earn anything back. This is the movement you'd talk a tired friend into — slow, kind, and short enough that there's no excuse. Hold each one for about a minute. Breathe the whole time.

1

Put it down 1 MIN

Stand or sit tall. Roll your shoulders back and down five times, slowly. Then let your arms hang completely heavy. Most of us carry a whole day in our shoulders before we notice we picked it up.

2

Unhunch 1 MIN

Clasp your hands behind your back (or hold a towel between them). Lift your chest, draw your shoulder blades together, and look slightly up. Hold for three slow breaths, release, repeat twice.

Seated: same thing, no standing needed.

3

Soften the neck 1 MIN

Right ear towards right shoulder. Let the weight of your head do the work — don't pull. Five breaths. Switch sides. If it's tender, go smaller; gentle is the point, not the compromise.

4

Wave the spine 1.5 MIN

On hands and knees: inhale, drop the belly and lift the chest; exhale, round the back and tuck the chin. Eight slow rounds, matched to your breath.

Chair version: hands on knees, same arch and round — it works just as well.

5

Fold, and let go 1.5 MIN

Feet hip-width, knees soft, fold forward and let your head and arms hang. Sway gently side to side. Stay for five breaths, then roll up one vertebra at a time.

Seated or low-energy: fold forward over your thighs, arms and head heavy. Same release.

ONE BREATH BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

In through your nose for four counts. Out through your mouth for six. Six times. The long exhale is the part that does the work — it's the signal your body reads as *you're safe now*.

Three questions

Now the part that changes the voice. Answer these out loud or on paper — not in your head. In your head is where the critic already lives.

QUESTION ONE

What am I actually saying to myself right now?

Write the sentence down word for word. Not the tidy version — the real one. It loses a surprising amount of its power on paper.

QUESTION TWO

Would I say that, in that tone, to someone I love?

Picture their face while you read it back. If you flinched, that's the answer — and that's the whole exercise working.

QUESTION THREE

So what would I say to them instead?

You already know. You're good at this part. Write it down — then read it back to yourself as though someone else wrote it for you.

THE WHOLE PRACTICE, IN ONE LINE

You don't have to love every part of yourself today. You just have to stop being the one person in your life who won't give you a break.

KEEP THIS ONE

Five things to say instead

For the moments you can't find the words. Screenshot this page, or tear it out and put it somewhere you'll see it on a bad day.

- Being tired is not the same as failing.
- The fact that I'm worried I'm not doing enough usually means I'm doing plenty.
- This will not be evidence of anything by next week.
- I'm allowed to be a work in progress and still be worth rooting for.
- I would forgive a friend for this in about four seconds.

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER ONE THING

Next time you catch yourself spiralling over something small, ask: **what would I say if this were my friend?** Then — and this is the hard part — actually listen.

THANK YOU FOR READING

This one is just for the people on my list — it isn't anywhere on my website. If it helped, hit reply and tell me. I read every single one.

*Talk next week,
Lili*